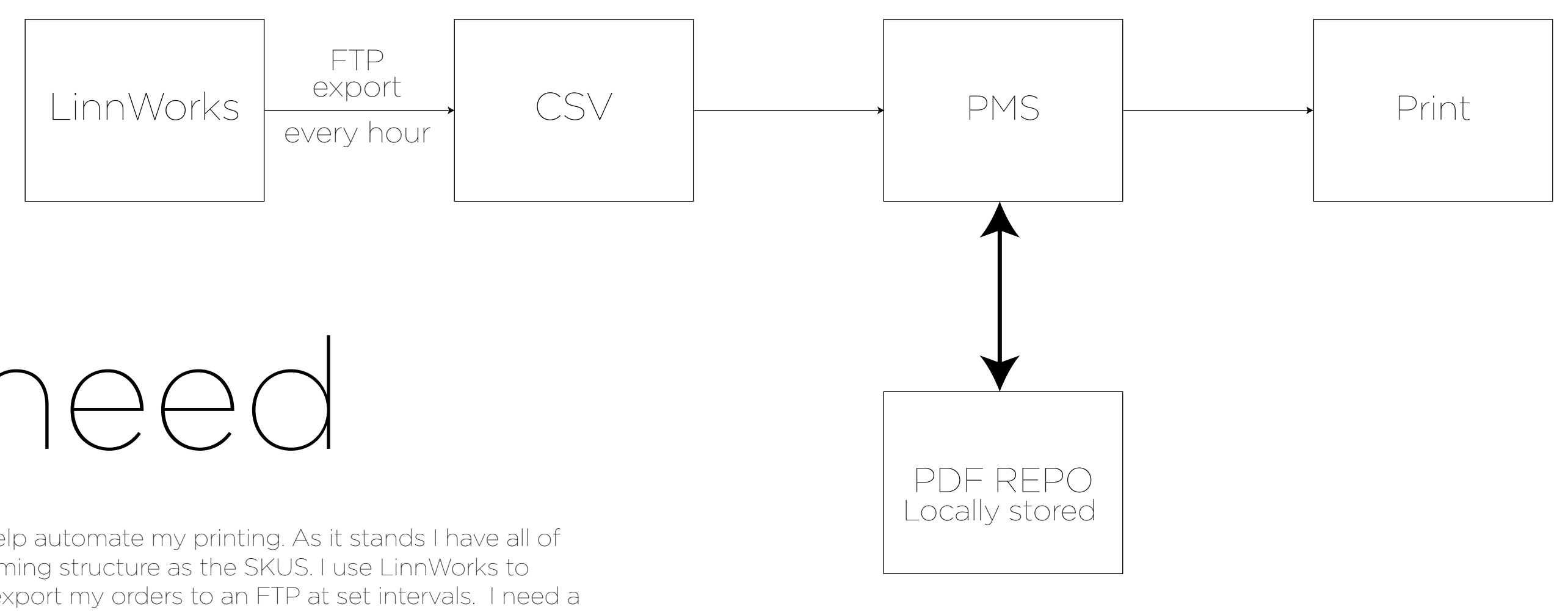
Print Management Software - PMS

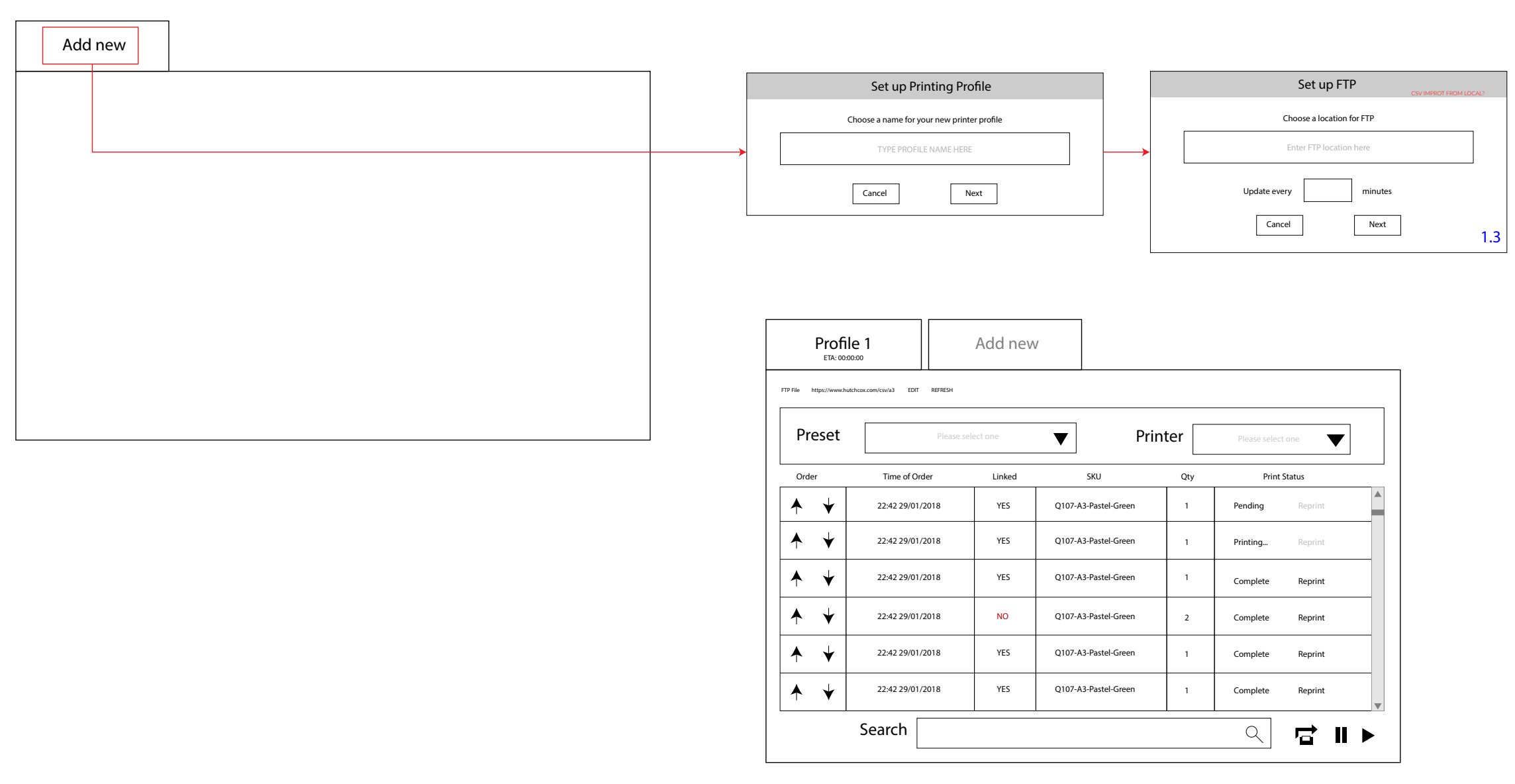


What I need

I am looking to get a bit of software made to help automate my printing. As it stands I have all of the artwork saved in pdf format in the same naming structure as the SKUS. I use LinnWorks to manage my orders, this tool also allows me to export my orders to an FTP at set intervals. I need a tool that can take this data and start to build up printing queues. I will set up multiple exports that will then need to be linked to profiles and printers. There will need to be a certain level of flexibility due to the nature of the industry.

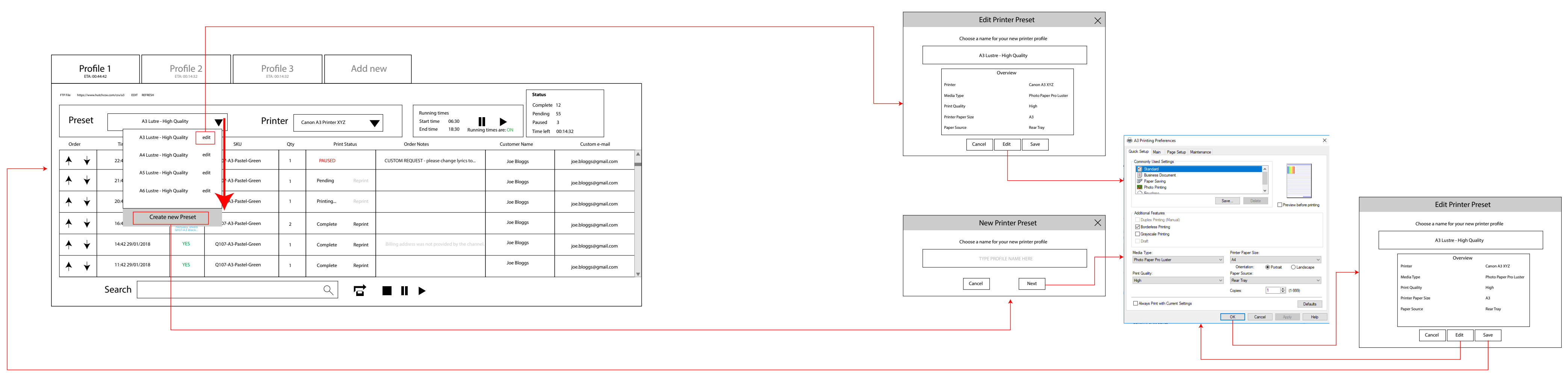
First time set up

First time set up will be setting up Print Profile and the FTP location of the CSV. Will need to be able to set as many profiles as needed. Ideally in a tab format. Am willing to use windows if it's easier.



Creating and editing Presets

Presets are used to quickly change between printer profiles. These need to save the settings from within the 'quick setup' Printing preferences. This the sections Additional Features, Media Type, Print Quality, Printer Paper Size and Paper Source.
The Printer drop down is just a list of all available online printers. Ideally I'd be able to assign the same preset to multiple printers.

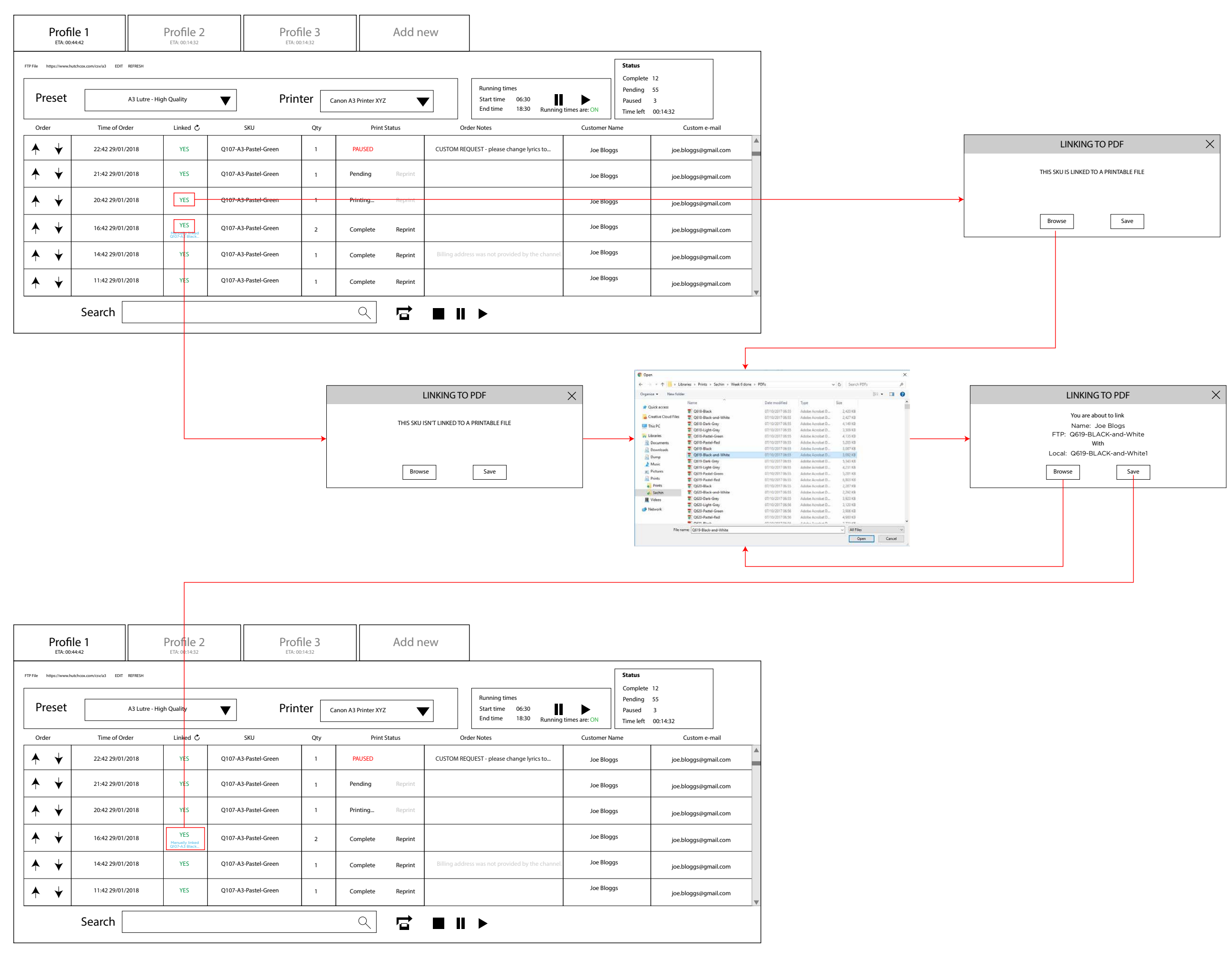


Import of CSV

The list will need to append up to 90days of orders from the ftp. This will run newest to oldest. The imports will be every 15/30/60 minutes. [This is set on screen 1.3] – open to discussion here.
Order – Will need to be able to move printing projects up and down the queue. They will run from bottom to top like the standard Windows Print Queue management.
Time of order- Displays the time/date the order was paid.
Linked – If they SKU has been matched correctly to the corresponding pdf. See flow
Quantity – Number of prints to be printed.
Print Status - Shows what has been printed, what is printing, what is pending and what is paused. Will need to be able to reprint directly from here.
Order Notes – Continue as normal if it says 'Billing address was not provided by the channel.' Anything else will set the print status to Pause. This will need to be checked be resumed by a human.
Customer name – Name from the csv
Customer email – email address from the csv

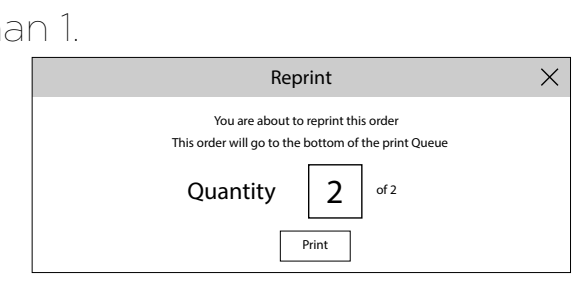
Linking to PDFs

All the printable PDF's will be stored locally in a folder. The file names will all follow the same format as the SKUS. However, there may be some exceptions which is why we need to be able to edit. If it has managed to link the SKU to a pdf it will display a green YES. If it is not able to find the corresponding SKU we will need to browse and link in manually/change the file name.
Mistake in the file name – Change the file name to the correct SKU. How will this update? Do we need a refresh button?
Custom order – The printer Status should be paused if they have left a customisation request on the Order Notes. Occasionally we will need to overwrite this. We will create the customer artwork and then reassign it here. This will need to remain linked to that order unless manually changed.
Reminder - Ideally show some sign/status that the order has been manually linked. What it has been linked to [file name]



Print Status

Paused – This will happen automatically if there is a message in the order notes that isn't 'Billing address was not provided by the channel.'
Pending – in the print queue
Printing – the current job
Complete – order has been printed.
Reprint – Can only reprint an order once it's been printed. Dialog box will ask for Quantity. Will always default to reprinting all. E.g. 2 of 2. Will be able to change this to just print 1 of 2. NOTE: This is only if a person has bought more than one of the same SKU and the CSV shows a quantity larger than 1.


Reprint

You are about to reprint this order
This order will go to the bottom of the print Queue

Quantity 2 of 2

Print

Order Notes

Order notes are left by the customer at checkout. If the message; 'Billing address was not provided by the channel.' Is left just ignore it. Anything else and the print status will need to be automatically paused. These are usually customisation requests.
User case – order comes in with the note "please can you add the message "love you forever Joe" to the bottom of the print" I will create the custom print in Illustrator, save it as the buyers name. Then I will use the Manual PDF linking to attach that customised print to that order. Once that is done I will select the row and press the play/resume button at the bottom. This paused prints will have to be manually resumed.
They will stay in order unless moved manually.

Search

Will store 90 days' worth of orders (discussion about how many is needed/possible) – Can be able to search through the list via; SKU, Customer Name, Date, email. Exact match only I assume would be quickest.

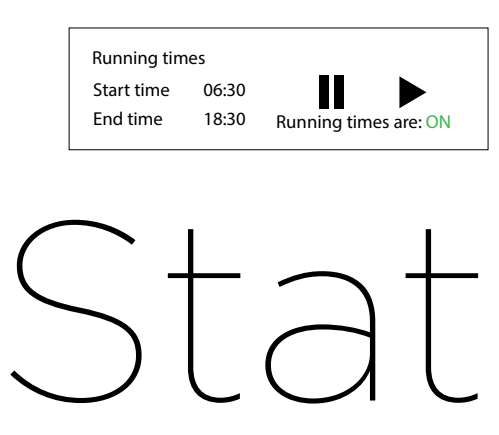
Search

Controls

Bottom right there are 4 icons. The main talking point here is to have some way of splitting the job over two printers. (the weird box arrow icon). The ideal scenario would be to have the ability to send half of the remaining print queue to another profile.
Square – select the row and then press this to cancel the current print job.
Pause – Puts everything in that profile on hold.
Play – Resumes all jobs in that profile. – Must resume from the bottom of the list.

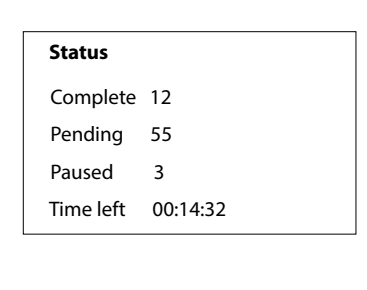
Running times

This is to quite simply set the start and end times of pending jobs. Ideally I would like to set the wake up time so the printing will just begin without me needed to be there. If there is no end time set have it so it will just keep printing unless paper or ink runs out.
Small status to show that the running times are set;; Running times are On/Off
Play and Pause for stop and start.


Running times
Start time 06:30
End time 18:30
Running times are: ON

Status

Just a quick snap shot of what the current job at hand. Would be great to see the estimated time left to complete all of the current pending prints. If we do go with a tab format at the top it would be ideal to show this under each tab name.


Status

Complete 12
Pending 55
Paused 3
Time left 00:14:32